Talking to the Dead: Religion, Music, and Memory

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Overview & Sanctuary Summary:
Religion, music, and lived ancestral memory among Gullah-Geechee women. A vital text on ancestral communion.

A powerful ethnographic study exploring how Gullah Geechee women preserve cultural autonomy, spiritual connection, and ancestral remembrance in coastal South Carolina and Georgia.

Sanctuary Themes:

• The Ring Shout & Spiritual Song: Trance, rhythm, and song as portals for ancestral presence and communal healing.

• Ancestral Dreams: How dreams serve as direct telephone lines to ancestors who offer warnings, recipes, and encouragement.

• Land and Sovereignty: Protecting sacred burial grounds and marshlands as living vessels of sacred memory.

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